

PREFACE

This new edition of the *Encyclopedia of Plants and Flowers* is a testament to the continuing value of this reference for gardeners. It is nearly 20 years since the first edition was published, and this special work continues to earn its place on any bookshelf.

We have endeavored to make information available to all on every aspect of horticulture. What makes this encyclopedia so special is the breadth of its appeal to both beginners and experienced gardeners. As a reference work, it covers all of the key areas of how to create a garden and provides detailed plant profiles in its extensive A–Z dictionary. It is the plant catalog, however, that really gives this book its wide reach, removing barriers to accessing information and providing inspiration for all gardeners. Structured according to garden use, plant form, color, and size, this section allows readers to find the plants they need without any prior horticultural knowledge. The detailed descriptions, accurate naming, and cultivation advice is of use to everyone. In all, this is the ideal introduction to garden plants and how to use them.

Garden plants continue to increase in diversity. Expert nurseries breed new forms and gardeners continually experiment with where and how to grow plants. These advances are especially important today, as the increasing impact of climate change presents us with both challenges and opportunities. This new edition is updated with some of these recent introductions, and reflects our most recent knowledge about our changing world.

As Director of Horticulture for the Royal Horticultural Society in the United Kingdom, I am privileged to be involved with all four of our established gardens—RHS Wisley, Rosemoor, Hyde Hall, Harlow Carr, and our developing fifth garden, RHS Bridgewater in Salford. Walking around these gardens with the curators and their teams, discussing new plans and developments, is to enjoy a living reflection of this encyclopedia. Every garden has a well-used copy, constantly referenced by both students and experienced staff to check facts and to catalyze new ideas.

Our thanks and gratitude is due again to the Editor-in-Chief, Chris Brickell. His name is synonymous with many of the books that helped galvanize my early interest in gardening and my subsequent training, so it's an immense pleasure for me to write this preface. I also wish to thank and acknowledge the extensive number of expert contributors for so freely sharing their knowledge. I am delighted to introduce this new edition, which I hope will continue to inspire all to garden.

A handwritten signature in black ink, reading "Tim Upson". The signature is written in a cursive, flowing style with a long, sweeping underline.

Dr. Tim Upson
Director of Horticulture, The Royal Horticultural Society, 2019